

DELIVERY LOGIC · FOR THE BUILD TEAM

KAYAN

The Engine Room

How a request becomes delivered, paid work — the matching engine, the brief-to-pod pipeline, and the economics of a Kayan engagement, set down so the team that builds it inherits the logic, not a guess.

Document	Companion to	Covers	Values
KAY-ER-001 · v1.0	The Talent Operating System	Matching · Pipeline · Economics · Fraud	Tokenised to F-01

· Where this sits

The first instrument took a person from the first tap to a verified profile and stopped at the edge of real work. This one crosses that edge. It specifies the three mechanisms that turn a verified registry into delivered, paid work: how the engine composes a team from a brief, how a client's request becomes a scoped and costed engagement, and how money moves through that engagement without ever being mistaken for revenue it is not.

It is written for the people who will build and run the delivery side. Where the companion document explains the human promise, this one carries the operating logic beneath it — deliberately, because a matching engine described only as "it finds the right people" will be built as someone's guess, and the guess will not hold Kayan's values. The values are in the mechanism here, not only in the prose.

ONE RULE ABOVE THE REST

Escrow is a liability until earned. What a client pays sits as money Kayan owes back as work is delivered; only the net management fee is ever income. Every figure, report, and screen in the delivery side must reflect this. It is the one architectural decision that survives the whole build unchanged.

1 The matching engine

The engine does not rank people and hand back a winner. It composes teams. Given a scoped brief, it builds two or three complete, valid pods — each one a different answer to the same need — and presents them with their reasoning so the client, with Kayan, chooses among real options rather than accepting a hidden verdict.

The engine never returns one answer. *A single "best match" collapses a trade-off the client is entitled to see. Speed against cost, certainty against development, a lean senior team against one that builds the bench — these are choices, and the engine surfaces them rather than deciding them in the dark.*

What it weighs

Every candidate is scored across these dimensions. The weights are a values decision as much as a technical one, and they resolve at F-01.

Dimension	Measures	Weight	How it behaves
Specialisation fit	How completely the person's verified specialisations cover what the brief names.	PH-W-SKL	Overlap on the taxonomy, weighted toward the specialisations the brief marks as core rather than incidental.
Relevant track record	Whether the person has finished work of this kind, in this sector, before.	PH-W-TRK	Counts accepted Kayan engagements first; declared external work counts less and only where evidenced.
Reliability signal	The person's completion and conduct history on prior pods.	PH-W-REL	Derived from finished engagements, on-time acceptance, and absence of upheld disputes. Never from a single event.
Availability in window	Declared capacity against the load the brief implies over its timeline.	PH-W-AVL	A person already committed to capacity cannot be scored up on skill alone; availability is checked before fit.
Language fit	Match on the working and deliverable language the brief requires.	PH-W-LNG	Arabic register and English proficiency handled separately; a translation brief weights both ends.
Location fit	Alignment with any physical-presence requirement in the brief.	PH-W-LOC	Neutral when the brief is remote-friendly; a hard gate, not a score, when on-site presence is mandatory.
Inclusion contribution	Whether adding this person advances the pod's standing on Kayan's inclusion commitment.	PH-W-INC	Applied to the pod as a whole, never to rank one person above another on identity. It shapes team composition, not individual selection.

What it will not trade

These are gates, not scores. A brief either clears them or is blocked from a configuration; no amount of skill buys past them.

Gate	Requirement	Why it is absolute
Tier floor	The pod lead clears the minimum tier the brief's stakes require; every member clears the floor for paid work.	A brief may be blocked from a configuration, never a person hidden.
No active sanction	No proposed member is under suspension or an unresolved conduct hold.	Checked live at composition, not at registration.
Real capacity	Each member has uncommitted hours in the brief's window.	Prevents a strong name being placed onto a plate that is already full.
No open dispute	No proposed member has an unresolved dispute touching the same client or domain.	Protects both sides from a known-bad pairing.
Identity sufficient for sensitivity	For briefs handling personal or sensitive data, every member's identity is verified to the required axis.	A safeguarding or data brief cannot be staffed with unverified identity, whatever the skill.

The three shapes it always builds

Configuration	What it is	Chosen when	The trade
Lean-Senior	The smallest team of the highest tiers. Fastest to move, highest day-rate, least coordination overhead.	Time-critical briefs, high-stakes deliverables, or clients who value speed and certainty over cost.	Higher cost; builds no bench; concentrates delivery risk in few people.
Balanced	The default shape. Right-sized to the work, a proven lead over a mixed-tier team, one rising member gaining exposure under supervision.	Most briefs. The configuration Kayan recommends unless the brief pushes toward an edge.	Neither the cheapest nor the fastest; the deliberate middle.
Development	A strong lead over deliberately more junior talent (T1–T2), priced lower, with a longer runway built in.	Briefs with schedule tolerance where the client accepts a development posture; advances the bench and the inclusion commitment at once.	Longer timeline; heavier supervision load on the lead; needs a client who understands the trade.

How a pod is composed

Within each configuration, roles are filled to a fixed shape, and the payout split by role is set before any work begins so no one negotiates their share against a colleague later.

Role	Tier	Payout share	Rule
Pod lead	T3 or T4	PH-SPLIT-LEAD	Exactly one. Accountable for acceptance, the client relationship, and the junior members' work.

Role	Tier	Payout share	Rule
Core contributor	T2 or T3	PH-SPLIT-CORE	One or more. Carries the substantive delivery in their specialisation.
Rising contributor	T1 or T2	PH-SPLIT-RISE	Optional. Present in Balanced and Development configs to build the bench under supervision.
Specialist advisor	T3 or T4	PH-SPLIT-ADV	Optional, fractional. Brought in for a narrow expert input, not full delivery.

EVERY MATCH IS EXPLAINABLE

A configuration is never delivered as a bare list of names. It carries its reasoning — why these people, why this shape, and what it costs relative to the alternatives — so the choice is informed and the engine can be audited against what it claimed.

2 From a request to a pod

A pod does not assemble itself; it is the last step of a pipeline that begins the moment a request arrives and does not commit a single person until a scope is agreed and the work is funded. The pipeline is built so that ambiguity is closed early, where it is cheap, rather than discovered in delivery, where it is not.

Stage	What happens	Owner	Gate to leave	Pipeline
BP-0 Signal	A request arrives — a form, a recorded note, a referral, a procurement notice. It is logged before it is judged.	POS-BRD-LEAD	Captured with a source and a named client contact.	S0 Identified
BP-1 Intake	The request is opened with a structured capture designed for a client who may not yet know what they need: the outcome wanted, for whom, by when, and what 'finished' would look like.	POS-MD-CO	A first Definition of Done exists, even if rough.	S1 Qualified
BP-2 Clarification	Kayan turns a loose ask into a specified need through a short guided exchange. Ambiguity is named and closed here, not discovered in delivery.	POS-MD-CO	Deliverables, constraints, and acceptance criteria are agreed in writing.	S2 Scoping
BP-3 Scoping	The specified need becomes a Statement of Work: deliverables, acceptance criteria, effort estimate, and a costed structure. This is the moment the engagement becomes real.	POS-MD-LEAD	A SOW draft exists with a costed structure and a proposed pod shape.	S3 Proposal
BP-4 Screening	Before anything is committed: sanctions and beneficial-owner screening, and any sector-compliance the brief demands — safeguarding for INGO work, data protection for technical work.	POS-COUNSEL	Screening cleared and recorded. No exceptions.	S3 Proposal (gate)
BP-5 Pod call	The matching engine runs against the scoped brief and composes two or three valid configurations, each with its reasoning and its trade-off. The client chooses among them with Kayan.	POS-TAL-ASM	A configuration is selected; every proposed member has confirmed availability.	S4 Negotiation
BP-6 Commitment	The SOW is signed and the engagement is funded into escrow. The pod is formed and kickoff is scheduled. Nothing before this line is work.	POS-FIN	SOW executed and escrow funded. The founding law holds: no SOW and no escrow means no work.	S5 Verbal / S6 Closed-won
BP-7 Delivery	The pod delivers against milestones. Each milestone passes an independent quality gate before the client is asked to accept it.	POS-MD-QA	Milestone accepted by the client on the agreed criteria.	Delivery

Stage	What happens	Owner	Gate to leave	Pipeline
BP-8 Release & recognise	On acceptance, funds release from escrow. Kayan's management fee — and only the management fee — is recognised as revenue. The talent payout is distributed. A holdback is retained to final acceptance.	POS-FIN	Payment released, fee recognised, payout distributed, holdback recorded.	Delivery
BP-9 Close & learn	Final acceptance releases the holdback. The engagement is closed, the pod's standing updated, and what was learned is written back so the next brief of this kind is scoped faster.	POS-MD-LEAD	Holdback released; standings updated; a closing note filed.	Won / archived

No SOW and no escrow means no work. *Nothing before commitment is an engagement. A conversation, a proposal, even a chosen configuration — none of it is work until a scope is signed and the money is held. The founding law protects the client from unbounded cost and the pod from unpaid effort.*

The intelligent intake

Most clients do not arrive with a specification. They arrive with a problem, sometimes half-formed. The intake is designed to draw a scope out of an outcome — to help a client who says "we need trained health workers" reach a brief precise enough to staff and cost. It asks for the outcome, never a task list:

The capture asks	And what it draws out
What are you trying to achieve?	The outcome, in the client's words — not a task list. 'We need trained health workers,' not 'we need a training.'
Who is it for?	The people who will use or benefit from the result. This shapes tier, sensitivity, and language.
How will you know it worked?	The client's own Definition of Done. If they cannot answer, the clarification loop supplies it with them.
By when, and why then?	The real deadline and what is driving it — a funding cycle, a launch, a report date.
What must it respect?	Constraints the work cannot break: a language, a standard, a donor rule, a compliance regime, a budget band.
What already exists?	Prior material, brand, data, or half-finished work Kayan should build on rather than redo.

HOW THE BRIEF CAN ARRIVE

Mode	For
Guided form	Structured questions with examples beside each, for clients who prefer to type.

Mode	For
Recorded brief	The client records a spoken description; Kayan transcribes and structures it. For clients who explain better than they write.
Referred / procurement	A procurement notice or a referral is opened directly into Intake with its documents attached.
Assisted session	For large or unclear briefs, a short guided session where Kayan draws the scope out in conversation.

3 The economics of an engagement

This is how money moves through a single piece of work — the structure, not the numbers, which resolve at F-01. Read top to bottom, it is the life of one payment: what the client pays, how it is held, what Kayan earns, what the people who did the work receive, and what the engagement finally contributes.

Line	Code	What it is	Computed	Note
Gross Project Value	GPV	What the client agrees to pay for the whole engagement.	Input	The contracted figure in the SOW.
Into escrow	ESC	On signature, the client funds the engagement into a held account. This is a liability Kayan owes back as work is delivered — it is not revenue and never appears as income.	= GPV	Held; releases only on accepted milestones.
Milestone release	REL	On each accepted milestone, its share of GPV releases from escrow.	= GPV × milestone %	The milestone schedule is set in the SOW.
Management fee	FEE	Kayan's charge for taking, assuring, and standing behind the work. This — and only this — is recognised as Kayan revenue.	= GPV × PH-FEE-BAND	The fee band varies by stream and complexity; PH-FEE-BAND resolves at F-01.
Platform cost to serve	COST	The direct cost of running the engagement: payment rails, verification amortised, hosting, dispute reserve.	= PH-COST-MODEL	A per-engagement allocation, not a guess; modelled in the workbook.
Talent payout pool	POOL	What flows to the people who did the work.	= REL – FEE – COST	Distributed within the pod by role weight.
Holdback	HOLD	A share of each payout retained until final acceptance, released only when the whole engagement is signed off.	= POOL × PH-HOLDBACK	Protects quality; returned in full on clean close.
Net contribution	NET	What the engagement contributes to Kayan after the direct cost of serving it.	= FEE – COST	The figure that tells whether an engagement type is worth running.

The rules the money obeys

1. Escrow is a liability until earned. Gross inflows are never revenue; only the net management fee is income. This is the one architectural decision carried through the whole build, and every report must reflect it.
2. Volunteer hours never enter this waterfall. They are not billed to a client and never touch the payout pool.
3. A pod cannot be funded against a brief with neither an agreed scope nor secured funds. No SOW and no escrow means no work.

4. The holdback is a quality instrument, not a margin. It returns in full on clean final acceptance; it is not Kayan's to keep.
5. The talent payout split is fixed by role in the SOW before work starts, so no one negotiates their share against a colleague mid-delivery.

WHY THIS IS MODELLED, NOT STATED

The companion workbook carries this waterfall as a live calculator. Enter a project value, choose a fee band, set the pod shape, and it computes the escrow schedule, the fee, the payout split, the holdback, and the net contribution. It runs symbolically on tokens today and numerically the moment the values resolve — so the day F-01 closes, the economics are already built, not still to be built.

Scenario A

An assessment for an international organisation

An international NGO needs a training-needs assessment for community health workers across three districts, delivered in Arabic and English, to a donor reporting deadline.

Segment	Sensitivity
INGO / Managed Delivery	High — safeguarding and personal data

Stage	What happens	What the system records
BP-1 Intake	A programme officer records a spoken brief. Kayan structures it: outcome is a usable assessment, users are the NGO's programme team and its donor, done means a report the donor will accept.	EV-BRIEF-CAPTURED fires; a Definition of Done is drafted.
BP-2 Clarification	A short exchange settles the districts, the sample, the language of the instrument, and the acceptance criteria the donor will apply.	Deliverables and acceptance criteria agreed in writing.
BP-3 Scoping	The SOW names four deliverables: instrument design, field data collection, analysis, and a bilingual report. Effort is estimated and a costed structure attached. GPV is set as PH-GPV-A .	SOW draft created; pod shape proposed.
BP-4 Screening	The NGO clears sanctions screening; because the work touches personal data and minors, safeguarding verification is required of every proposed member.	Screening recorded; identity axis raised for this brief.
BP-5 Pod call	The engine returns three configurations. Lean-Senior: two T4 specialists, fastest, highest cost. Balanced: a T4 assessment lead, a T3 field lead, a T2 analyst, one rising member on the instrument. Development: a T3 lead over three T1–T2 members, lowest cost, longest runway.	Three configurations, each with its reasoning and trade-off.
BP-6 Commitment	The client chooses Balanced — it meets the deadline, respects the budget, and advances the bench. The SOW is signed; PH-GPV-A is funded into escrow as a liability. The pod forms.	SOW executed; escrow funded; EV-POD-FORMED fires.
BP-7 Delivery	Four milestones. Each passes an independent quality gate held by a QA position outside the pod before the client is asked to accept.	Milestones accepted in sequence.
BP-8 Release	On each acceptance, that milestone's share releases. Kayan recognises only its management fee, PH-GPV-A × PH-FEE-BAND , as revenue. The payout pool distributes by role. A holdback is retained.	Fee recognised; payout distributed; holdback recorded.
BP-9 Close	The donor accepts the final report. The holdback releases in full. Standings rise for every member; the rising contributor's evidence is logged toward their next tier. A closing note makes the next assessment of this kind faster to scope.	Holdback released; standings updated; learning captured.

Scenario B

A quick-return brief for a diaspora client

A Yemeni founder abroad needs 10,000 rows of Arabic text annotated to a published quality standard, paid through an international rail, on a short timeline.

Segment	Sensitivity
Diaspora / Managed Delivery	Low — no personal data

Stage	What happens	What the system records
BP-1 Intake	The founder submits a guided form; the standard and the row count make the Definition of Done almost self-writing.	Brief captured; DoD near-complete on intake.
BP-2–3 Scope	One deliverable, one clear acceptance test: agreement against a gold set at a stated threshold. GPV set as PH-GPV-B ; a lean pod proposed.	SOW draft with a single measurable acceptance criterion.
BP-4 Screening	Sanctions screening on the client; low sensitivity means the standard identity axis suffices.	Screening cleared.
BP-5 Pod call	The engine favours Lean-Senior for a short deadline: two T3 annotators under a T3 lead with a published quality method. A Balanced option adds a rising member for a slightly longer runway.	Two configurations offered.
BP-6–8 Deliver & pay	Lean-Senior chosen. Escrow funded through the international rail. Delivery passes the quality gate against the gold set. Fee recognised at PH-GPV-B × PH-FEE-BAND ; payout distributed.	Delivered, accepted, fee recognised, paid.

4 The fraud and abuse surface

An institution whose product is trust has to assume it will be attacked and design as if it already has been. Each vector below is treated as a failure mode: how it works, what it costs if unchecked, the signal that catches it, and the control that answers it. The companion workbook scores each on severity, likelihood, and detectability, and computes a priority number so attention goes where the exposure is greatest.

Vector	How it works	If unchecked	The signal	The control	Owner
Borrowed or stolen identity	Someone registers using another person's documents.	A person Kayan cannot actually stand behind is placed on client work.	Liveness check fails to match the document; device and contact patterns diverge from the claimed identity.	KYC liveness plus document authentication at S05/S06, with a human review before any tier above registration.	POS-TAL-VER
Passed-off portfolio	An applicant submits work they did not produce.	A skill claim is verified that the person cannot deliver, and the first client discovers it.	Reverse-image and originality checks flag prior publication; the interview probe cannot reconstruct the work.	Originality screen on submitted evidence, plus a live task or interview that only the true author could pass. A machine flags; a person decides.	POS-TAL-VER
Reference collusion	Fake referees, or a ring of applicants vouching for each other.	Track record is fabricated across a cluster of accounts.	The same referees recur across unrelated applicants; referee contact details fail independent verification.	Referees contacted independently through verified channels; pattern detection on shared referees across the registry.	POS-TAL-VER
Sock-puppet accounts	One person opens many accounts to multiply chances or evade a past sanction.	Sanctions are escaped and the registry's numbers are corrupted.	Duplicate device, contact number, or identity signature at KYC.	Deduplication on identity, contact channel, and device at registration; a suspended identity cannot re-enter under a new account.	POS-TECH-LEAD
Points farming	Manufacturing volunteer hours to accumulate points.	Standing is inflated without real contribution.	Hours logged without a matching verified assignment or supervisor sign-off.	Volunteer hours count only against a real assignment with a supervisor's confirmation; points can never buy a tier, a task, or money, so farming them yields nothing priced.	POS-K4Y-CO

Vector	How it works	If unchecked	The signal	The control	Owner
Off-platform poaching	A pod member takes the client off Kayan to avoid the fee.	Revenue is lost and the client loses escrow protection and dispute cover.	Client contact goes quiet mid-engagement; requests to move communication off-platform.	The value that keeps both sides on-platform — escrow protection, dispute cover, and continued flow of work — reinforced by the engagement terms. Off-platform solicitation is a conduct breach.	POS-MD-LEAD
Self-graded quality	A pod signs off its own work to clear a milestone.	Substandard work reaches the client under a Kayan acceptance.	Acceptance requested without an independent gate record.	Quality gates are held by a QA position outside the pod; a pod can never accept its own milestone.	POS-MD-QA
Sanctions evasion through a front	A sanctioned party contracts through an intermediary.	Kayan transacts with a prohibited entity — the gravest exposure in the model.	Beneficial ownership is opaque; the paying entity differs from the contracting one.	Sanctions and beneficial-owner screening before S3, with no exception, and a re-check if the paying party changes.	POS-COUNSEL
Client-data exfiltration	A member leaks or reuses client data.	A confidentiality breach and a legal exposure for Kayan.	Access patterns outside the member's task; data leaving controlled storage.	Least-privilege access scoped to the task, watermarked deliverables, an audit trail on every access, and an NDA where the brief requires it.	POS-TECH-LEAD
Retaliatory standing attack	A bad actor tries to tank a rival's standing with false reports.	An honest person is demoted on manufactured signals.	A dispute or complaint with no verified engagement behind it.	Only verified engagements move standing; unverified reports cannot demote. Disputes route to a human, never to an automatic penalty.	POS-TAL-LEAD

A machine may flag; only a person may fail one. *Every control here detects and routes. None of them convicts. An automated signal opens a case for a human position to judge — because a false accusation, acted on automatically, is its own kind of harm.*

5 Making the numbers act

A dashboard that is only watched is decoration. The governing indicators earn their place by being tied to a rhythm and a response: at each interval, a specific signal is checked against a threshold, and a breach triggers a named action owned by a named position. This is what turns the share of the registry ever placed from a figure into a control.

Rhythm	What is reviewed	The signal	Threshold	Action if breached	Owner
Weekly	Verification queue depth against intake	Registrations waiting longer than the service standard	PH-QUEUE-SLA	Throttle new registration intake until the queue clears; the registry does not grow faster than it can be verified.	POS-TAL-LEAD
Weekly	Pipeline movement	Briefs stalled in one stage beyond the expected days	PH-STAGE-AGE	The stage owner is prompted; a stalled brief is either advanced or closed, never left to rot.	POS-MD-LEAD
Fortnightly	Pod utilisation	Verified talent with no placement in the period	PH-IDLE-DAYS	Idle verified talent is surfaced to matching first on the next brief; persistent idleness signals a taxonomy or demand gap.	POS-TAL-ASM
Monthly	Share of registry ever placed	The governing indicator, against target	PH-PLACED-TARGET	If below target, intake slows and matching effort rises. A large unplaced registry is treated as a failure, not a milestone.	POS-CEO
Monthly	Quality gate pass rate	Milestones failing first-pass acceptance	PH-QA-PASS	A falling pass rate triggers a review of scoping quality and rubric calibration, not a push on the pods alone.	POS-MD-QA
Monthly	Net contribution by engagement type	Fee earned against cost to serve, by stream	PH-NET-FLOOR	An engagement type running below the floor is repriced or retired; the workbook shows this the moment F-01 resolves.	POS-FIN
Quarterly	Fraud and dispute pattern	Upheld disputes and flagged attempts by vector	PH-DISP-RATE	A rising vector reopens its control in the fraud register; residual risk is re-scored.	POS-COUNSEL

Rhythm	What is reviewed	The signal	Threshold	Action if breached	Owner
Quarterly	Inclusion standing	Pod composition against the inclusion commitment	PH-INC-TARGET	Where standing slips, the Development configuration is weighted up in matching until it recovers.	POS-CEO

What this adds to the decision session

This instrument opens five forks. None blocks the build; each is a value that resolves alongside the talent-side placeholders in a single session, after which the models compute.

Fork	The decision	Why it matters
F-06	The management fee band PH-FEE-BAND by stream and complexity.	Sets revenue on every engagement; the whole economics model waits on it.
F-07	The talent payout split by role [[PH-SPLIT-*]] .	Determines what each pod role earns; fixed in the SOW before work starts.
F-08	The holdback share PH-HOLDBACK and its release trigger.	A quality instrument; must be set before the first engagement funds.
F-09	The matching dimension weights [[PH-W-*]] .	Tunes what the engine optimises for; a values decision, not only a technical one.
F-10	The governing thresholds PH-PLACED-TARGET , PH-NET-FLOOR , and the cadence SLAs.	Turns the dashboard from a mirror into a control.